Georgia Elects Keisha Lance Bottoms as First Black Woman Governor in U.S. History

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Georgia voters made history this week. They elected Keisha Lance Bottoms as the state's first **Democratic governor** in more than two decades, and the first Black woman ever elected **governor** in the United States. Bottoms is the former mayor of Atlanta. She campaigned on lowering the cost of living, expanding health care, and pushing back against the Trump administration. She will take office in a state where Republicans still control the **Senate**, so she will need their support to pass many of her plans. Her family has lived in Georgia for at least five **generations**. She can trace her roots to a **plantation** in Crawfordville, where her great-great-grandparents were once **enslaved**. She said being elected **governor** has exceeded every dream she ever had for her life. Bottoms said the win came from decades of work by people across Georgia. Georgia has not elected a **Democratic governor** since 1998. Her message is to listen to voters and focus on daily life, especially the cost of living. Democrats also won the Georgia House and are one seat away from controlling the **Senate**.

Word Treasure

governor -- A governor is the leader of a state.

Democratic -- Democratic means belonging to the Democratic Party, one of the two main political parties in the United States.

Senate -- A Senate is a group of lawmakers who help make the laws for a state or a country.

plantation -- A plantation is a large farm where crops were grown.

enslaved -- Enslaved means forced to work for someone else with no freedom and no pay.

generations -- Generations are the people in a family who live at different times, like grandparents, parents, and children.

Background you need

A governor is the leader of a state, and people choose the governor by voting in an election.

In Georgia, voters picked Keisha Lance Bottoms, who was the mayor of Atlanta, a big city in Georgia.

A governor works with lawmakers to make plans about daily life, like the cost of living and health care, and needs their support to pass new plans.

Break it down

WHO: Georgia voters and Keisha Lance Bottoms, the former mayor of Atlanta.
WHAT: Voters elected Bottoms as governor of Georgia, the first Black woman ever elected governor in the United States.
WHERE: Georgia, in the United States.
WHY: Voters chose her message of listening to people and focusing on daily life, especially the cost of living.

Why it matters

A governor helps make choices about things that touch your family's daily life, like the cost of living and health care.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Georgia voters elect as governor?

(A) The Georgia Senate
(B) Keisha Lance Bottoms
(C) The voters of Georgia
(D) The Trump administration

2. What makes this election a first in the history of the United States?

(A) The first governor from Crawfordville
(B) The first governor who was once a mayor
(C) The first Democratic governor Georgia ever had
(D) The first Black woman ever elected governor in the United States

3. Which of these did Bottoms promise to work on?

(A) Lowering the cost of living
(B) Raising the cost of living
(C) Ignoring what voters say
(D) Making health care harder to get

4. What job did Bottoms have before she was elected governor?

(A) President of the United States
(B) Member of the Georgia Senate
(C) Mayor of Atlanta
(D) Member of the Georgia House

5. Why will Bottoms need support from Republicans to pass many of her plans?

(A) She has no plans to pass
(B) Democrats control the Senate
(C) Republicans still control the Senate
(D) Georgia has no Senate

6. Where did Bottoms say her great-great-grandparents were once enslaved?

(A) On a plantation in Crawfordville
(B) In the Georgia House
(C) In the United States Senate
(D) In Atlanta

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Keisha Lance Bottoms: She says leaders should listen to voters and focus on daily life, especially the cost of living, and she campaigned on lowering costs and expanding health care.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):